PARENT GUIDANCE · DESIGN SYSTEM

Parent Guidance — Design Guidelines

Design system of the PG-Live prototype · Updated October 15, 2026

Guidelines for the **PG-Live** prototype (parentguidance.org), written from the **prototype's real code** (`src/app`).

- **The visual identity** (colors, typography, radii, shadows, buttons and animation) is defined with tokens and closed scales.
- **The method:** everything comes from tokens, closed scales, button hierarchy, accessibility and a reduced-motion contract.

> **Status:** the prototype follows these guidelines (chapter 5). Every new screen or component must follow them from the start.

Contents

#	Guide	Content
1	Foundations	Palette, contrast, Poppins typography, spacing, radii and shadows
2	Buttons	Styles, sizes, states, the `<Button>` component and accessibility
3	Layout	Containers, breakpoints, vertical rhythm, grids and patterns (cards, filter bar, banners, pop-ups, legal pages, video) and Figma components
4	Motion	Animation with `motion` , durations, easing and reduced-motion
5	Quality standards	Accessibility, visual consistency, Figma and open items

PDF version: `docs/guidelines/pdf/` has one PDF per guide plus one with all of them (`Parent-Guidance-Design-Guidelines-complete.pdf`). They are generated from these `.md` files with `tools/build-pdf.mjs` ; when a guide changes, they need to be generated again.

Spanish version: the same guidelines in Spanish live in `docs/guidelines/es/` , with their PDFs in `docs/guidelines/pdf/es/` .

Where everything lives

File	What it is
`src/styles/tokens.css`	CSS variables (`--pg-*`) and their Tailwind v4 mapping (`bg-pg-navy` , `rounded-pg-md` , `shadow-pg-card` , `max-w-pg-page` …)
`src/styles/accessibility.css`	Global visible focus and the reduced-motion rule
`src/components/ui/Button.tsx`	`<Button>` , `<ButtonLink>` , `<ButtonAnchor>` and `buttonClass()`
`src/components/cards/UnifiedCard.tsx`	Standard card (resources, courses, help lines)
`src/components/patterns/EventModal.tsx`	Event pop-up (accessible dialog pattern)
`guidelines/Guidelines.md`	Short summary for **Figma Make** (the file its AI reads when generating screens)

Visual personality

Parent Guidance supports families through sensitive topics (mental health, crisis, parenting). The interface must feel **warm, calm and trustworthy**:

- Warm cream background, deep navy text and teal/sage accents.
- Soft shapes: rounded corners, subtle navy-tinted shadows, never hard black ones.
- Calm motion: short, gentle entrances, nothing that bounces or blinks.
- Readability first: the audience is parents, often on their phones and under stress.

Principles

- Token rule: no hex, size or shadow written "by hand"; everything comes from `tokens.css` .
- Closed type and spacing scales; any new value is assigned the nearest step.
- Button hierarchy: one Primary per section, labels that start with a verb, complete states (Focus, Loading, Disabled), 32 / 40 / 48px sizes on the 8px grid, 48px touch height on mobile.
- Grids that degrade in steps (3 → 2 → 1 columns).
- Safe, unhurried motion with duration bands and a mandatory reduced-motion contract.

Rule #1

> No color, font size, radius or shadow is written as a loose value (`text-[#1c3243]` , `text-[13px]` , `shadow-[…]` , `text-gray-700`). Use the tokens in `tokens.css` . If something is missing, first add it as a token here (and in Figma), then use it.

Accepted exceptions: colors inside SVG logos (brand art), course category palettes (data colors) and reading widths of hero text (`max-w-[480px]` …).

How to check a screen

1. Review it at **390, 768, 1024 and 1280px**: no horizontal scroll and no squeezed text.
2. Go through it with the keyboard (Tab, Enter, Esc): everything clickable can be reached and shows focus.
3. AA contrast on all text (table in section 1.1).
4. Buttons use the component, headings follow the scale, no bouncing animations.